

Carrot and stick: On the U.S. and Iran talks

The 2015 **accord** must be revived to prevent Iran going nuclear

The U.S. and Iran are currently engaged in rare high-stakes **diplomacy**. They have held two rounds of talks, in Muscat and in Rome, with Oman as the **mediator**, about Tehran's nuclear programme. A third technical round has been confirmed for the coming days. However, tensions still remain high between the Trump administration and the Islamic Republic. It was Donald Trump, during his first **term**, who **sabotaged** a **functioning multilateral** agreement that had significantly **curtailed** Iran's nuclear programme. Ever since, Iran has **accelerated** its nuclear activities. While it has not yet decided to build a nuclear bomb, most **assessments** agree that it has the capability to do so within weeks. At the same time, Iran's regional influence **stands diminished** as a result of Israel's attacks on its **so-called axis of resistance** and other regional shifts such as the **fall** of Syria's Assad **regime**. Israel is **pressing** for an attack on Iran's nuclear facilities, but **Mr. Trump**, according to American reports, **has vetoed** those plans, for now.

Mr. Trump has adopted a classic carrot-and-stick approach. He said he wanted a deal with Iran but with a warning that if talks failed, there would be bombing. He has also launched a massive **aerial** campaign against Yemen's Iran-aligned Houthis. In addition, the U.S. has **ramped up** its military presence in West Asia besides moving B-2 bombers to the Indian Ocean region — all aimed at signalling to Iran that U.S. threats should be taken seriously. But despite the combined military **might** of the U.S. and Israel, **any attack** on Iran **would** be **catastrophic** for regional security and global economy. Iran's nuclear facilities are **scattered** and **underground**, making them extremely difficult to destroy. It was precisely because there was no **viable** military solution to the Iran nuclear issue that world powers chose the path of diplomacy in 2015, a path Mr. Trump had **abandoned** in 2018 for no good reason. **Nevertheless**, despite the challenges and geopolitical pressure, the recent **initiation** of talks by Mr. Trump and Iran **opens** a rare **window of opportunity** to resolve the issue once and for all. For diplomacy to succeed, the U.S. should act as a responsible global power that is **committed** to preventing **weaponisation** of Iran's nuclear programme, rather than as a **partisan patron** seeking to destroy Iran on Israel's behalf. **Iran**, for its part, **has** signalled that it was open to **scaling back** its nuclear activities in exchange for the removal of **sanctions** and threats. The 2015 **agreement**, which limited Iran's **enrichment** capabilities and uranium **stockpile**, **could** serve as a reference point for a deal if talks progress **constructively**.

[Practice Exercise]

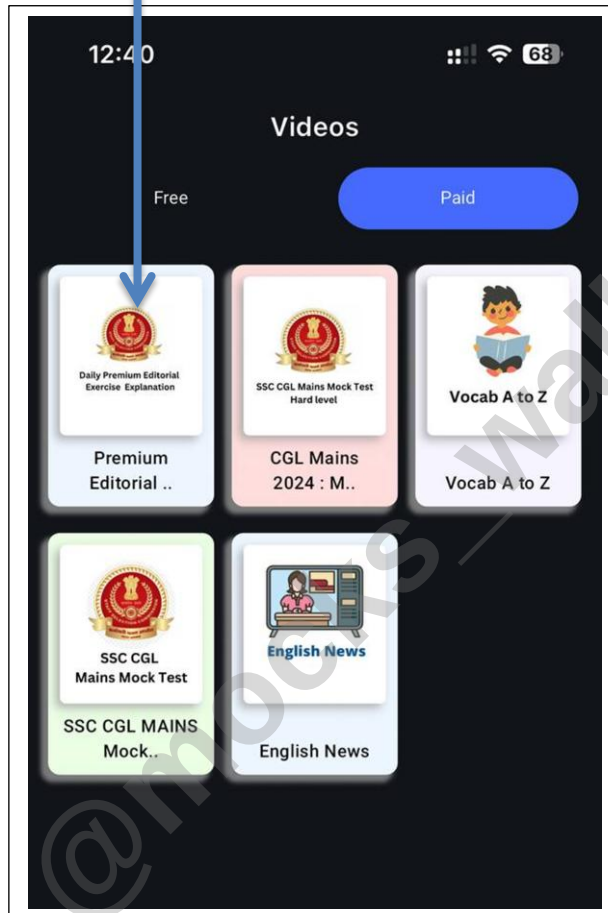
- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Carrot and stick** (phrase) – a system in which you are rewarded for some actions and threatened with punishment for others पुरस्कार और दंड की नीति
2. **Accord** (noun) – agreement, pact, treaty, settlement, understanding समझौता
3. **Diplomacy** (noun) – negotiation, dialogue, talks, mediation, foreign policy कूटनीति
4. **Mediator** (noun) – negotiator, intermediary, facilitator, peacemaker, arbitrator मध्यस्थ
5. **Term** (noun) – period, duration, tenure, span, phase अवधि
6. **Sabotage** (verb) – destroy, damage, undermine, subvert, wreck विध्वंस करना / नष्ट करना
7. **Functioning** (adjective) – working, operating, running, active, effective कार्यशील
8. **Multilateral** (adjective) – involving many sides, international, collective, cooperative, polycentric बहुपक्षीय
9. **Curtail** (verb) – reduce, restrict, cut down, limit, decrease कम करना
10. **Accelerate** (verb) – speed up, hasten, quicken, boost, expedite तेजी लाना
11. **Assessment** (noun) – evaluation, analysis, appraisal, estimation, review मूल्यांकन
12. **Stand** (verb) – remain, exist, endure, hold, persist स्थिति में होना
13. **Diminished** (adjective) – reduced, weakened, lessened, decreased, shrunk घटा हुआ
14. **So-called** (adjective) – alleged, supposed, claimed, purported, nominal तथाकथित
15. **Axis of resistance** (noun) – an informal coalition of Iranian-supported militant and political organizations across the Middle East. प्रतिरोध का गठबंधन
16. **Fall** (noun) – collapse, downfall, defeat, overthrow, demise पतन
17. **Regime** (noun) – government, administration, authority, rule, system शासन
18. **Press** (for) (verb) – demand, push, advocate, urge, insist ज़ोर देना
19. **Veto** (verb) – reject, block, forbid, refuse, cancel रोक लगाना
20. **Aerial** (adjective) – airborne, flying, overhead, skyborne, atmospheric हवाई
21. **Ramp up** (phrasal verb) – increase, boost, escalate, build up, intensify तेजी से बढ़ाना

22. **Might** (noun) – strength, power, force, muscle, authority शक्ति
23. **Catastrophic** (adjective) – disastrous, devastating, ruinous, calamitous, tragic विनाशकारी
24. **Scattered** (adjective) – dispersed, spread, strewn, sprinkled, distributed बिखरा हुआ
25. **Underground** (adjective) – subterranean, buried, hidden, covert, below surface भूमिगत
26. **Viable** (adjective) – feasible, practical, workable, achievable, possible व्यावहारिक
27. **Abandon** (verb) – forsake, desert, leave, renounce, relinquish छोड़ देना
28. **Nevertheless** (adverb) – however, yet, still, though, even so फिर भी
29. **Initiation** (noun) – beginning, start, commencement, inception, launch प्रारंभ
30. **Window of opportunity** (phrase) – a favourable opportunity for doing something that must be seized immediately. मौका
31. **Committed** (to) (adjective) – dedicated, devoted, loyal, bound, faithful प्रतिबद्ध
32. **Weaponisation** (noun) – militarization, arming, deployment, conversion to weapons, armament शस्त्रीकरण
33. **Partisan** (adjective) – biased, one-sided, prejudiced, partial, sectarian पक्षपाती
34. **Patron** (noun) – supporter, sponsor, benefactor, backer, protector संरक्षक
35. **Seek** (to) (verb) – attempt, try, pursue, aim, endeavour प्रयास करना
36. **Scale back** (phrasal verb) – reduce, decrease, lessen, cut down, shrink कम करना
37. **Sanction** (noun) – penalty, restriction, embargo, punitive measure प्रतिबंध
38. **Enrichment** (noun) – the action of increasing the proportion of a particular isotope in an element, especially that of the isotope U-235 in uranium so as to make it suitable for use in a nuclear reactor or weapon. संवर्धन (परमाणु संवर्धन के संदर्भ में)
39. **Stockpile** (noun) – reserve, hoard, store, accumulation, collection भंडार
40. **Constructively** (adverb) – positively, productively, usefully, beneficially, helpfully रचनात्मक रूप से

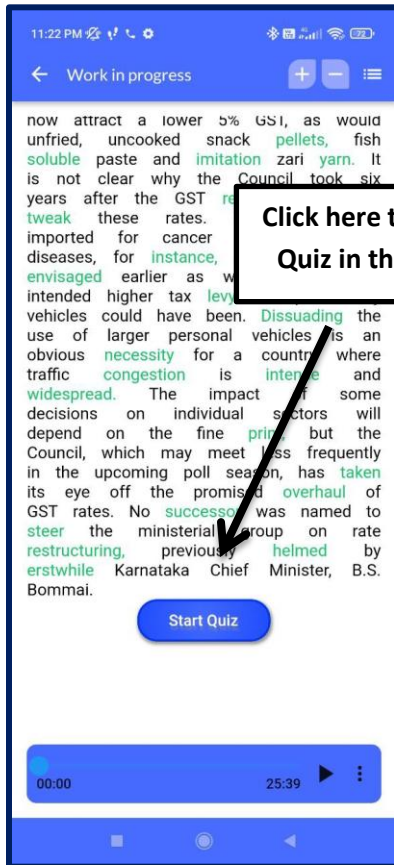
Video solution of Practice Exercise from this Editorial is exclusively available on App.



Summary of the Editorial

1. The U.S. and Iran are engaged in rare high-stakes diplomacy, holding two rounds of talks in Muscat and Rome with Oman as mediator.
2. A third technical round of discussions between the two sides has been scheduled.
3. Tensions persist due to the Trump administration's earlier decision to dismantle the 2015 multilateral nuclear accord.
4. Following the collapse of the agreement, Iran has accelerated its nuclear programme and now has the capability to build a bomb within weeks, though no final decision has been made.
5. Iran's regional influence has weakened, partly due to Israel's military actions and changing dynamics like Syria's political shifts.
6. Israel is urging for a military strike on Iran's nuclear sites, but Mr. Trump has currently vetoed such plans.
7. Trump is using a classic "carrot-and-stick" strategy: offering talks with the threat of military action if diplomacy fails.
8. The U.S. has intensified military pressure by launching attacks on Yemen's Iran-backed Houthis and boosting its presence in West Asia.
9. B-2 bombers have been deployed to the Indian Ocean to further demonstrate American military resolve.
10. Despite these moves, a military attack on Iran would have catastrophic consequences for regional security and the global economy.
11. Iran's nuclear facilities are deeply buried and dispersed, making them extremely difficult to target and destroy through strikes.
12. Diplomacy was chosen in 2015 because no effective military solution existed to the Iran nuclear issue.
13. The current talks offer a rare window of opportunity to revive diplomatic efforts after years of escalating tensions.
14. For diplomacy to succeed, the U.S. must prioritize non-proliferation over acting as a partisan player supporting Israeli interests.
15. Iran has indicated willingness to scale back its nuclear programme in return for sanction relief, with the 2015 accord serving as a potential framework for a new deal.

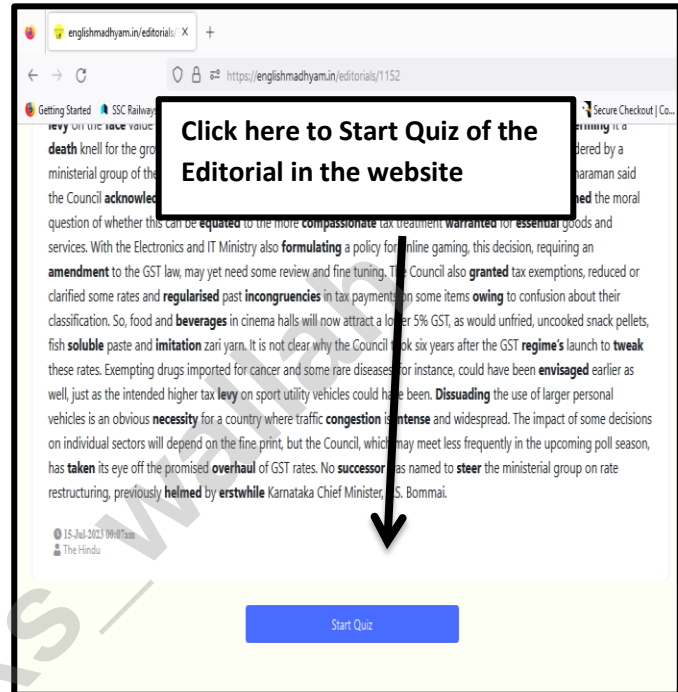
Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



Click here to Start
Quiz in the App

Start Quiz

[Click here to download App](#)



Click here to Start Quiz of the
Editorial in the website

Start Quiz

[Click here to visit website](#)



Learn Vocabulary Through Reading Articles

English Madhyam